

Seawall height in Manalapan

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

MANALAPAN · PALM BEACH COUNTY

No minimum set in local code

Manalapan requires a permit and fixed wall lines for seawalls but sets no seawall height.

The detail

MINIMUM	None set - Ch. 155 Coastal Structures, Sec. 155.60-155.64
LOCATION	Ocean seawalls on the adopted sea wall line - Sec. 155.45-155.49; Lake Worth bulkhead/fill line - Sec. 155.30-155.33
MAINTENANCE	Seawalls must be kept impervious to sand, built to applicable codes - Sec. 155.64
THE OCEAN SEAWALL LINE	Adopted by Ord. 51 (20 Nov 1965). Building anywhere other than on the official line needs Town Commission approval, and that owner bears the cost of connecting to the neighbouring wall - Sec. 155.45-155.46
UNLAWFUL WALLS	Owner has 30 days after notice to remove, then the Town Manager removes it at the owner's expense - Sec. 155.47-155.48
APPLICATION	Filed with the Town Building Department, stating the work's cost and distance into the Atlantic, whether federal, state and county permits are granted, with complete engineering drawings - Sec. 155.61-155.62

Where this comes from: Town of Manalapan Code, Title XV Ch. 155 Beaches and Waterways (Municode)

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1

Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2

Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3

Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4

Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.